

Top 10 for 2010

Small, brawny or sheer luxury. The auto majors are lining them all up. The definitive list for car buyers.

By Yogendra Pratap

Big is better and brawn is great. Indians want SUVs, whether they be for as low as Rs 5 lakh or as high as a crore. If it is not an SUV, it is a people-mover. But like the rest of the world, when it comes to the daily run, they want a "compact" which is really an euphemism for a small car. Small is definitely the new big and the world watched with keen interest the developments on this front in India. Small wonder, then, that almost every player in the world is now looking at India as a small car hub.

For the first time, multinational companies are carefully studying the Indian market, deciphering its needs, desires and aspirations, and then developing cars which will be sold around the world and, at times, manufactured in India. With Suzuki realising that its future is in India, it has been slowly shifting its focus. It was not surprising as India became Suzuki's largest market, surpassing even Japan. But the other three Japanese majors—Toyota, Honda and Nissan—have followed. The global premieres of their small concept cars happened in India, and Nissan has already announced that its new small car will be manufactured at its new plant in Chennai to be sold around the world. Not to be left behind, Volkswagen, in its quest to become the number one



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BMW X1

PRICE: RS 25 LAKH (Estimated)

USP An entry-level vehicle into the world of sheer driving pleasure. Always wanted to own an SUV? Here's your chance. Not too big for city roads, but with the advantages of an SUV.

3

FORD FIGO

PRICE: RS 4 LAKH (Estimated)

USP Ford has been getting better at making automobiles for India and has started offering cars that are a good value-for-money proposition. The small Figo promises to be a good all-round package.